TimeBack Privacy Policy

Effective date: November 6, 2026

TimeBack is a free iPhone app that locks the apps you choose when you tap an NFC tag, scan a QR code, start a Lock In timer, or reach a scheduled time. This policy explains what TimeBack does with your information.

The short version

- **TimeBack does not collect any data.** Nothing you do in the app is sent to the developer or to anyone else.
- There are **no accounts, no servers, no analytics, no ads, no tracking, and no third-party code** (SDKs) in the app.
- TimeBack does not connect to the internet at all.
- Everything the app saves stays on your iPhone, and deleting the app deletes it.

What stays on your iPhone

TimeBack saves a few things on your device so it can work. None of it leaves your phone.

What	Why it's kept
Your tags: name, color, chosen apps, the NFC tag's serial number, and a random secret for its QR code	So TimeBack knows which apps each tag locks and can recognize the tag when you tap or scan it
Lock In sessions and schedules (apps, times, days)	So timed sessions and schedules lock and unlock on time, even while the app is closed
Stats: when tags were locked and unlocked, how long apps stayed blocked, and when a Lock In ended early	To show your history on the Stats screen
Settings, such as Auto Lock, redundant locking, and whether you've seen the tutorial	To remember your choices

TimeBack's block screen, its background monitor, and its home screen widgets are parts of the same app. They share this data through an App Group on your device so they can show the right lock status. They don't send it anywhere either.

Screen Time (Family Controls)

TimeBack uses Apple's Screen Time frameworks (Family Controls, Managed Settings, and Device Activity) to block apps. You give permission once, and you can turn it off at any time in the Settings app under Screen Time.

When you choose apps, websites, or categories to block, Apple's system picker gives TimeBack only **anonymous tokens**. TimeBack can't see the names of the apps you pick or which apps are installed on your phone, and it can't see how you use any app. It only asks iOS to block or unblock those tokens. Apple handles this data under Apple's Privacy Policy.

NFC tags

When you tap a tag, TimeBack reads only the tag's serial number (its unique ID) to recognize it. It doesn't read or change anything else stored on the tag.

Camera

If you scan a tag's QR code, TimeBack uses the camera only while the scanner is open, to read the code. No photos or video are saved or sent anywhere. You can turn camera access off in Settings > TimeBack.

QR codes you save or share

TimeBack makes a QR code for each tag. If you choose to save, print, or share it, that goes through the standard iOS share sheet to the place you pick. Anyone who scans that code in TimeBack on your phone can lock or unlock that tag, so keep it somewhere safe.

Shortcuts and widgets

TimeBack offers a “Tap TimeBack Tag” action in the Shortcuts app and widgets for your home screen. These show your tag names and lock status on your own device and don’t share them with the developer.

Backups

Like most apps, TimeBack’s data can be included in your iPhone’s iCloud or computer backups if you have backups turned on. Those backups are handled by Apple, or stored on your computer, under your own settings.

Deleting your data

Delete the TimeBack app to remove everything it saved. Since the developer never receives any of your data, there is nothing else to delete.

Children

TimeBack is meant for people managing their own phone and collects no personal information from anyone, including children.

Changes to this policy

If this policy changes, the new version will be posted at this address with a new effective date. If TimeBack ever starts collecting any data, this policy will be updated before that happens.

Contact

Questions about this policy? Contact the developer through GitHub (@DillPickle613).